Scars

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Mature

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Graphic Depictions Of Violence

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

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by Midnight_Owl2

Summary

Catra had a feeling that she and Adora were being spied on. She kept seeing dark shadows every now and then. She had to investigate. One night, curiosity gets the better of her and she's led to the place her nightmare come true. Will Adora be able to rescue her in time? How will Catra escape this living nightmare?

Notes

This fic is an alternate version of one of the chapters in my original fic: Together at the End of the World. To understand this fic, I highly advise reading Together at the End of the World first. This chapter is the alternate version of TATEOTW Chapter 16 (Scars). Be warned, this chapter version my be graphic to some readers. Hope you enjoy.

See the end of the work for more notes

"*Hello, Catra."*

I turn to find Shadow Weaver looming behind me. I feel trapped, unable to move.

"What a pleasant surprise this is to have to show up in my chambers unannounced. It's been so long since we last spoke. I was beginning to wonder if Lord Hordak had finally seen how worthless you are and had finally sent you Beast Island. Unfortunately my shadow spies told me otherwise. I wonder how Lord Hordak would feel knowing that his most *'loyal'* and superior ranking soldiers are the true traitors."

Shadow Weaver's wicked voice slices through the air, making the area feel even colder than before. Pure evil is written across her face. I knew from the first moment I met her she was evil and this only reinforces that fact. I guess this is what she meant by *'this isn't the last you've seen of me.'*

Whatever you do, don't let her know you're afraid.

"So you've been the one sneaking around watching our every move."

"No not me, my *shadow spies*. In case you have forgotten Catra, I have been trapped here since the day Adora took my position from my hands. I had high hopes for her but never thought I'd be pushed aside. I've been trapped here plotting my revenge ever since. I was only trying to find Adora's weaknesses but I found out something far more interesting in the process."

Shadow Weaver floats further towards me. I extend my claws ever slow slightly prepared to attack. It may have been a while or two since Shadow Weaver last attack but I still remember where to strike.

"I discovered about yours' and Adora's plan to end this war. It was me who was spying on you the day Scorpia and Entrapta left the Fright Zone. It was me who was spying on you when you

squadron when they found out your true plan. It's a shame so many have suffered from *your* failure to protect them, especially that young girl. What's her name… *Six?*"

A low growl emits from my throat. She has no right to talk about Six. She never met her or even cared about her.

"*Ah yes, Six*. She would do anything for those she saw as her family. Such as shame that a young person with such skill and intelligence had her life taken from her because *you* couldn't protect her. It's very similar to how you failed to protect Adora when we attacked Salineas. Face it Catra, if you had got up and ran for your life when those rocks started to fall Adora would have been fine. The scars on her body are a reminder of how *you* failed. You were always a failure Catra, and that's all you'll ever be."

No! That's not true! Adora scars show her how far she's come, the challenges she's faced and how she strives through each and everyone. I may have failed to protect her once but I kept my promise… right? I won't fail her again.

"What are you going to do to me?"

This is clearly all simple chatter before she does something to me. Shadow Weaver does this all the time, I'm used to her game… *make you feel like you deserve your punishment before she strikes.*

Shadow Weaver chuckles under her mask. "Oh I have nothing planned especially for you. It's what I plan to do to *Adora*."

"If you dare touch her…"

"You'll do what? I fully intent for you not to be around when get my revenge on Adora. Besides, the best way to hurt someone it to go for the *heart*."

Shit, it all makes sense now. Shadow Weaver plans to kill me to take revenge on Adora.

"YOU BITCH!" I dart forwards with every intention to hurt, even kill Shadow Weaver if I must. I won't let her do this!

Unfortunately for me, before I can do any damage to Shadow Weaver, she catches me in s series of dark tendrils and tosses me towards the jagged wall.

"Ahhhhh!"

I scream as my body slams against that wall. I quickly regains my strength and dodge another four attempted attacks. I locate Shadow Weavers' blind spot. I pounce and target her back, digging my claws into the back of her cloak. She falls to the ground hunched over in pain or at least that's what I thought. Dark shadows form behind me, tossing me off Shadow Weaver, before pinning my to the ground. Red electricity starts to form around my body and the shadows begin tightening, attempting to crush bones and suffocate me. I try to escape but there is no way out. I am physically trapped.

"You're weaker than I thought Catra. You clearly don't know the true power of dark magic… and now it will be the death of you."

I try even harder to escape the shadows grasp but the more I fight the tighter they get and the more the electricity burns. It burns straight through my fur and cuts into my flesh. I scream in pain but I know all too well that no one can hear me… *is this really the end?*

"Any last words, *Catra?"*

I have no final words, only final thoughts… *Adora*. I'm sorry I failed her. I can only hope she finds a way to end this war without me.

Shadow Weaver forms some sort of ball, which it contained by that evil red electricity in her hands. I close my eyes waiting for this nightmare to finally be over.

BANG, CLANK, BANG!

The door screeches open. I give it all my strength to see who it is as i try to call for help one last time. It's...

“Adora?”

How did she know I was her?

“GET AWAY FROM HER!” She shouts as she charges at Shadow Weaver.

“*Adora*, how nice of you to...” Adora quickly shuts her up by punching her directly in the stomach and she isn’t finished yet. Adora aims wherever she can, making sure Shadow Weaver can’t use her hands under any circumstances. If she can’t use her hand, she can’t cast spells.

“I warned you if you ever hurt Catra again you’d be sorry!” Adora rages between attacks.

I start to fight my way out of the shadows. With Shadow Weaver occupied they’ve started to loosen their grip but the pain they’re causing just from trying to escape still cuts likes knives. It’s a pain I’ll work through to protect Adora.

I’m free, I’m finally free. My skin burns but I’m free.

Adora is focused on keeping Shadow Weaver occupied, both of them unaware I have escaped her dark powers. I make my way behind Shadow Weaver once again to her blind spot. Adora’s fall to the ground with a thud. She wipes away some blood running from the side of her lip with the back of her hand. Her sword in its dagger form has fallen to the side.

How did she manage to sneak that in here?

She reaches for it but Shadow Weaver uses her magic to swipe it to the back of the room, right where I’m hiding. Thank stars she hasn’t seen me yet. I reach for the dagger and move myself behind the Black Garnet.

"*Adora*, why must you be like this? That creature is clearly not worth any of this. What could you possibly see in her?"

"Her name is Catra and I love her!"

I haven't got much time. I need to act fast if I stand any chance of protecting Adora.

"You love her?!" Shadow Weaver cackles with that evil laugh of hers. "The one who's responsible for your near death experience? Hah. It's a shame really. I had such high hopes for you Adora. It's a shame *your Catra* couldn't protect even at the end."

Shadow Weaver forms another ball of red electricity in her hands but this time aims it at Adora. I'm not going to let her hurt her. This ends now, once and for all!

"HEY SHADOW WEAVER!"

"Catra?" Adora says as she looks up above Shadow Weaver in shock.

I dived down from the top of the Black Garnet, my claws extended as far as they'll go. Shadow Weaver turns around but with her hands occupied she isn't able to block my attack. The dagger pierces straight through Shadow Weavers heart with no mercy. Shadow Weaver stumbles around, her back now facing the Black Garnet. With one powerful kick to her chest, I propel Shadow Weaver backwards, sending her directly in the direction of the Black Garnet. Adora manages to catches me as I fly backwards, helping me find my feet.

"You said it yourself Shadow Weaver. The best way to hurt someone is to go for the *heart*."

Shadow Weaver slowly sumps to the ground. The red diamond on her mask slowly starts to fade. Adora walks forward and rips the dagger from her chest. It's over.

Adora turns to face me and notices the blood, the burns, and the cuts that are visible through my ripped uniform. My knees give way and I fall to the ground but Adora manages to catch me. My body starts to shake and tears start to fall from my eyes. Then I notice Adora's eyes have begun to water too. She has a few cut's on her cheeks and chin but nothing to serious.

I'm not sure why I suddenly feel so… *empty*. Maybe it's the shock that I feel or the relief that this living nightmare is finally over. For a while nothing is said but then Adora speaks… "We should go."

"Okay" Is all I'm able to say. Adora helps me up and carries me out of the room. I look back one more time before the door closes behind us.

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This is my least favourite place to be but all I want right now is a shower. Adora helps me undress and turns the shower on. For once it's running warm. It's probably because there are less people here than usual, only Adora and I are here.

"I'll join you in a minute." Adora says as I step in the shower.

The running water soothes my skin. It stings a little when it hits my injuries but the pain is worth it if it means my wounds don't get infected. Besides, the pain is only temporary. The water starts to change from bright red to clear, my injuries become clearer too. They're going to scar for sure. Tears start to fall down my face again and I hold myself. I feel Adora's arms make their way around my waist pulling me closer to her. I turn in her hold and cry against her shoulder as she reassures me that this nightmare is finally over.

"Thank you" I say through a series of hiccups as my tears subside.

Adora holds me close and places a series of kisses to the top of my head, ears, cheeks and finally my lips. She helps me wash the rest of my body free of blood, being extra careful to avoid were I have been burned and scarred. We eventually dry off and head back to our quarters to patch each other up.

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"How did you know where I was?" I ask as Adora straps up one of the burns on my leg. It stings slightly but she being so careful and caring through this all. *What did I do to deserve her?*

"I woke up from one of my nightmares and realized you weren't here. I was about to panic but then I saw that your uniform was gone. I remembered you saying that you saw something a few times and I decided to investigate myself. I took my sword because… *you know*… and then I heard you screaming. I might not have been able to protect you the first time it happen, *or a few times after that*, but I wasn't going to let her get away with it again Catra. I promised to look out for you and I swore to make her regret everything she ever did to you."

"Adora I'm so sorry I wasn't there when you woke up. I…"

"Hey it's okay. I get it. You had to go see what it was. I would have done the same thing. I'm just glad you're okay. Catra I was worried sick when I found out where you were. I was worried she was going to kill you."

"You know that was her plan right? She was going to kill me to hurt you."

Adora's hand reach for mine and she holds them ever so tightly. Her other hand rests on my cheek, her thumb brushing through my fur.

"I don't know what I would have done if I lost you Catra. You're my world, my everything. At least now we no longer have to live in fear of her every again. *We're going to be okay."*

Adora draws me into a hug and I slightly wince in pain. Her hug is gentle and warm. I feel safe in her arms. She eventually releases me but looks at me with concerned eyes.

"You ready to sort that one out?" She asks as she points to my back.

It's the most painful injury of the night. Adora describes it as a series of electric burns along the right side of my back. They spread from my shoulder blade to my tail bone. We agreed to leave disinfecting and patching it up till last as it was the most painful to clean in the shower.

"Better now than never I suppose. Just warn my before you do anything."

Adora kisses me gently before moving to sit behind me.

"This is going to sting a bit. You ready?"

I take in a deep breath and nod my head letting Adora know I'm ready.

"Shit!" I growl through gritted teeth. It burns all the more. My hands grips the sheets of the bed and my tail instinctively wraps around Adora's arm.

"Are you okay?"

"Yeah, I'm fine. It burns that's all. Can you please hurry up and get this over with."

Adora works swiftly to disinfect the area. My tail grips her working arm tighter. This is something I used to do when we were younger. Whenever something really hurt, I'd wrap my tail around Adora's arm. It kept her close to me and reassured me that

everything was going to be okay, she was only trying to help. My eyes start to water from the pain.

Why would anyone want to inflict pain like this upon someone? Oh wait, this is Shadow Weaver we're talking about!

"All Done."

I'm relieved it's finally over. Hopefully, I can now get some rest. With Adora occupied putting the medical kit away I look at my now patched up injuries. All I see is a wounded animal, unable to defend themselves from a vicious predator who took advantage of their prey's weaknesses. My body shaking and my vision becomes unclear from how watery my eyes are. I thought my tears would have run dry by now but clearly not. Adora notices and rushes to my side.

"Catra what's wrong?"

I try to speak but my words run dry. My vision starts to blur but the feeling of Adora's hands on my shoulder and the sound of her voice grounds me.

"Catra try and calm down. Focus on my voice. It's okay we're safe. I'm here, I'm not going anywhere."

I listen to Adora carefully and follow the patterns of her breathing. Breathe *in, hold, breathe out… repeat… breathe in, hold, breathe out.*

I open my eyes once more and clear images starts to form. I'm met with those beautiful blue eyes staring back at mine. They show concern, patience but above all, love.

"Are you okay. I know that's a bit of a stupid question to ask after what just happened but I need to know if you feel okay to talk."

I take a deep breath and wipe my eyes clear from my tears. "I'm fine, well I'm not but I'm alright to talk. Can you hold me for a bit… please."

Adora smiles and moves to my side, pulling me into her lap. My tail wraps around us both, my claws hold on tight to her night shirt, my head tucked under her chin. Adora holds me close and softly hums as she gently strokes behind my ears. Once I'm calm enough I let me heart open up to her.

"How can you still love me after everything?"

"What do you mean?"

"Shadow Weaver… she-she made me realize that I'm the reason you got hurt. I-I'm the reason you nearly died at Salineas. I'm responsible for Scorpia and Entrapta having to leave the Horde. Six is dead because of me. I'm the reason everyone keeps getting hurt."

It's hard to keep the tears back. My eyes will for sure be red and sore in the morning.

"Catra I want you to listen to me okay and I mean really listen. If you hadn't found me at Salineas when we were being attack we wouldn't have won. If you hadn't stopped to find help when taking me back to the Fright Zone I wouldn't be holding you right now. Scorpia and Entrapta are alive and are helping us win this war because you got them out of here safely. Six, despite how upsetting her ending was, learned to trust again thanks to you. I learned to love because I met you. Catra you are the reason people are surviving. You're the reason why people are learning to change, to live, to trust and to love."

"But how can you still love me with these scars?"

Adora looks down at me in shock. I move out of her hold so I can face her properly. I don't know where it came from but it's how I feel right now. After everything how can she still love me?

"Look at me Adora. I'm weak. I'm worthless."

"Catra don't say things like that. Your none of those things..."

"But that's how I feel Adora. I'm covered in burns and wounds that you patch up every time. Those injuries leave scars, a permanent mark on my skin. Sure my fur hides some of them but they're still there. How can you still want to be with me after everything. You could have left the Horde after Thaymor but you chose to stay. How can you still want me in your life when nothing good in my life ever seems to last. How can you love me when I don't even know how to love myself?"

Adora remains smiling at me, her hand keeps a tight hold on mine. Once she's certain I have finished, she reaches for my other hand and hold its tight.

"I love you Catra because you're true to yourself. When I'm scared or worried about something I think to myself *'what would Catra do?'* I wish I had your confidence, your sense of humour, your skill, your passion. I'm still learning how to love myself but loving you is making it easier. You should never be ashamed of who you are. Your scars, regardless of whether they're visible or not, do not make you weak or worthless. They make you strong. They tell stories of the battles you have been through to overcome the barriers to get where you are today. If I have to kiss every scar on your body to make you realize that then so be it. I'll keep doing that until you see yourself the way I see you. You are the strongest, most daring and most caring person I know Catra. Nothing is ever going to change the way I feel about you. I love you. I always have and I always will."

Adora pulls me into a gentle, heartfelt kiss. She kisses every single scar on my body both old and new, before laying us down to try and get some rest. I wrap around Adora's body and she holds me close, protecting me from my nightmares.

How I ended up with someone like her in my life I will never know, but I'm thankful to be the one she chose to love. I thank the stars that I get to call her mine… *My Adora.*

End Notes

If you have read the original fic, you'll understand that Shadow Weaver had it coming. After everything she put these two through, both in the childhood and adulthood, there was no way she was going to get away with what she did.

This chapter was actually the original version, but I wanted to make it so Shadow Weaver has her own power used against her. That version made it in the final version of TATEOTW. Hope you enjoy reading this version.

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!